



Designing the Mind

Building AI Products Through a UX Lens — my field log on
building a reusable cast of ten characters with an AI that can't draw.

How to Crush a Job Interview



The material

- Short-form video
- Talking head
- No b-rolls

The ask

It started with the simplest possible brief.

“Can you generate b-roll for this video?”

I can't generate actual video footage — I don't have video generation capability, so I can't hand you ready-to-drop b-roll clips. Being upfront about that so you're not waiting on something that isn't coming.

Claude's
answer

Claude generates no images and no video.
It reads, reasons, and writes — that's it.

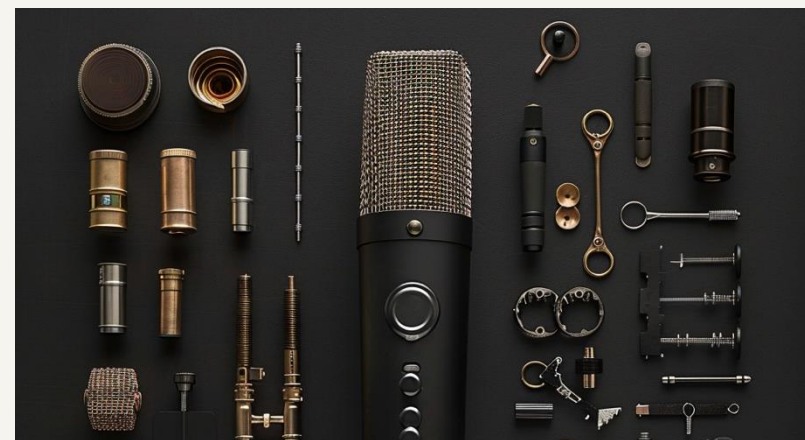


That “can't” turned out to be the most useful constraint in the whole project.

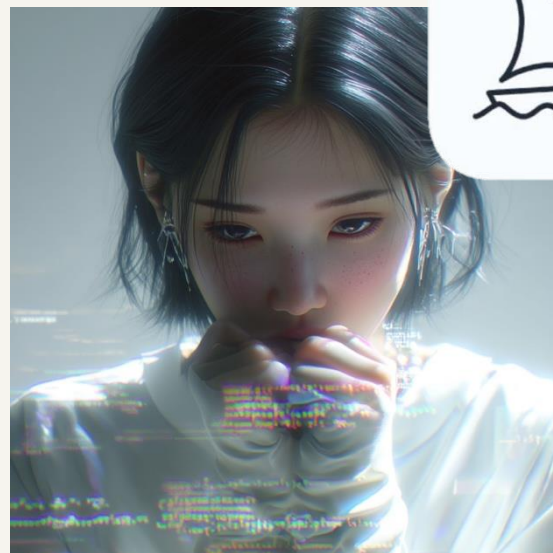


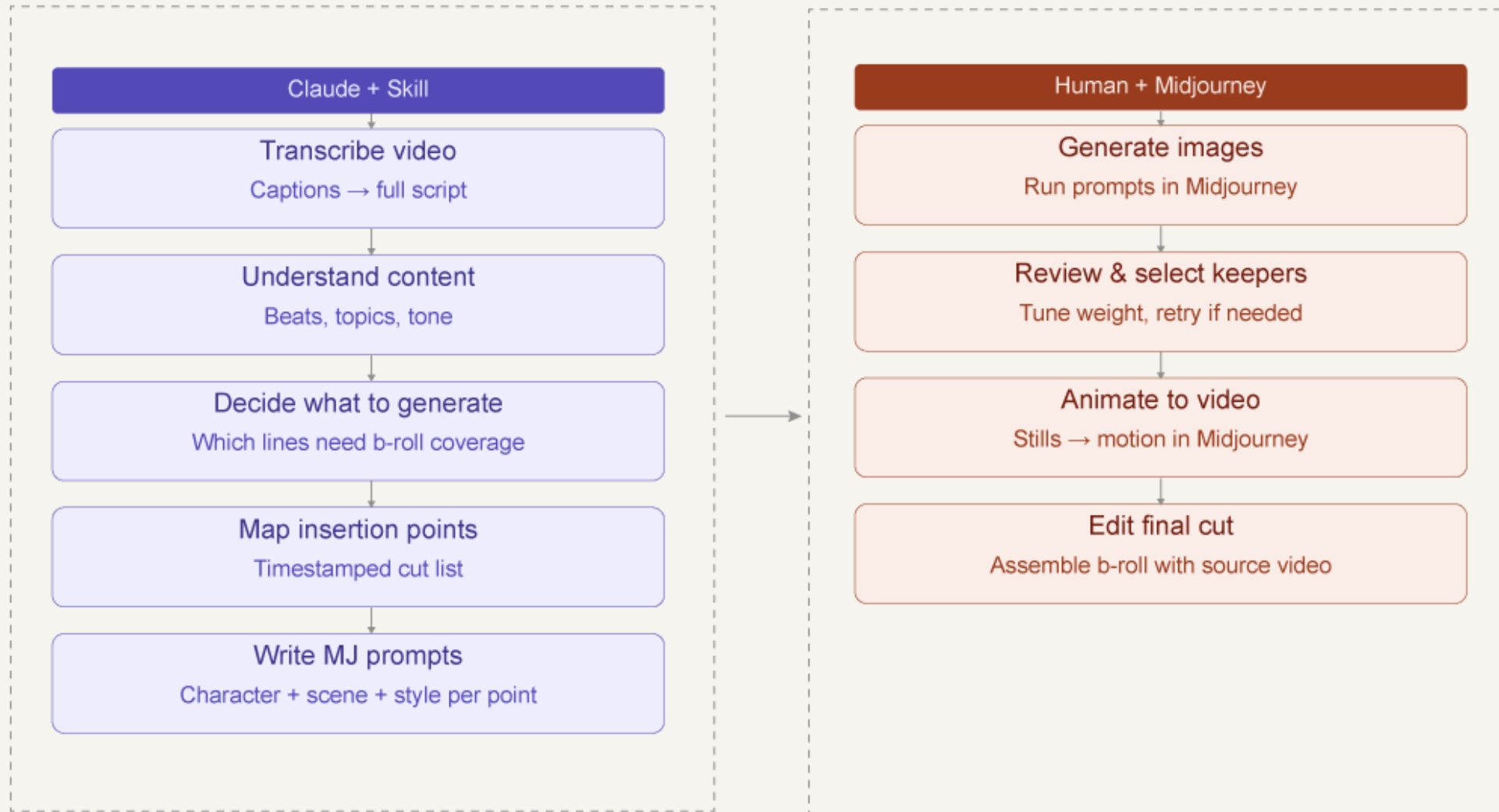
What do you think?

- Fully automated workflow – trustworthy?
- Does AI know how to make good judgment?
- What will happen if there is no human agency?



The "Great Wall"





The UX lens: Nielsen's heuristics, in this story

I didn't plan them — they emerged from what the tools did and what I had to fix.

1 • Visibility of system status

2 • Match with the real world

3 • User control & freedom

4 • Consistency & standards

5 • Error prevention

6 • Recognition over recall

7 • Flexibility & efficiency

8 • Aesthetic & minimalist design

9 • Recover from errors

10 • Help & documentation

Without planning to, this became a heuristic evaluation.

1 Visibility of System Status

Designs should *keep users informed* about what is going on, through appropriate, timely feedback.



Interactive mall maps have to show people where they currently are, to help them understand where to go next.

2 Match between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts *familiar to the user*, rather than internal jargon.



Users can quickly understand which stovetop control maps to each heating element.

Nielsen Norman Group

Jakob's Ten Usability Heuristics

3 User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They *need a clearly marked "emergency exit"* to leave the unwanted action.



Just like physical spaces, digital spaces need quick "emergency" exits too.

4 Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. *Follow platform conventions.*



Check-in counters are usually located at the front of hotels, which meets expectations.

5 Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully *prevent problems* from occurring in the first place.



Guard rails on curvy mountain roads prevent drivers from falling off cliffs.

8 Aesthetic *and* Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information which is irrelevant. Every extra unit of information in an interface *competes* with the relevant units of information.



A minimalist three-legged stool is still a place to sit.

6 Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. Avoid making users remember information.



People are likely to correctly answer “Is Lisbon the capital of Portugal?”.

9 Recognize, Diagnose, *and* Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.



Wrong-way signs on the road remind drivers that they are heading in the wrong direction.

7 Flexibility *and* Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — may speed up the interaction for the expert user.



Regular routes are listed on maps, but locals with more knowledge of the area can take shortcuts.

10 Help *and* Documentation

It's best if the design *doesn't need* any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users complete their tasks.



Information kiosks at airports are easily recognizable and solve customers' problems in context and immediately.

NN/g

www.nngroup.com/articles/ten-usability-heuristics/

AI's job: Read the source

Before any b-roll, the work was analysis — not generation.

Read the burned-in captions → reconstruct the full script

Map a cutaway to each beat on a timestamped cut list

Decide which lines should stay on the speaker's face

Knowing what not to cover is half the craft.

Chat

Cowork

Code

New chat

Projects

Artifacts

Customize

Recents

B-roll generation for video

AI presentation topic ideas for JB agentic

Transferring EdD programs to a better-fit

Adapting debate script for 3x3 format

Converting Bahasa Melayu audio lessons

Cybergatekeeper agent won't delete from

Transcribing and organizing qualitative res

Simplifying advanced presentation langua

Chinese broadcasting camp volunteer sch

Finding previous conversation threads

Adding kami to Claude

Converting Word document to Google for

Obsidian MCP installation requirements

Logo design for R & K Co.

Translating assignment descriptor to Engl

Relaunch to update

v1.13576.4

Design

Labs

Kelley · Pro

B-roll generation for video

“Can you put all the details in a table?”

them on the conceptual beats and deliberately keeping his face on the two punchlines ("Don't ever do that" and the power question itself), because covering those kills the impact. Six inserts instead of seven:

#	Cut TO b-roll	Cut BACK	Covers (line)	B-roll shot	Search terms
1	0:00.5	0:03	"I write resumes... advice I give to everybody"	Hands typing/editing a resume on a laptop	resume editing laptop close up, cv on screen
2	0:03	0:08	"every employer always asks this question... at the end"	Interview across a desk; interviewer glancing at notes/clock	job interview office desk, interviewer checking notes
3	0:08	0:11	"Oh no, I think you covered everything!... trying to be polite"	Candidate shrugging, awkward polite smile	nervous candidate shrug interview, awkward forced smile meeting
—	KEEP FACE	0:11-0:12	"Don't ever do that."	No cut — stay on him, land	—
—	KEEP	0:12-	"If you hire me today	Stay on him; optionally	—

You're now past your plan's included usage. Your session limit resets at 3:40 AM.

Claude Fable 5 is currently unavailable.

Learn more

Write a message...

Opus 4.8 High

Claude is AI and can make mistakes. Please double-check responses.

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UX • Consistency and standards

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Character inconsistency

Character consistency is a prerequisite for generating seamless, continuous animations.

“Can we have consistent characters across all b-rolls?”

The problem

Random stock clips have no identity and no through-line. Nothing ties one video to the next.



The idea

A small recurring cast — a visual signature people start to recognise, reused across scenes and videos.



Design the people once; reuse them everywhere.

Idea to overcome inconsistency: a recurring cast

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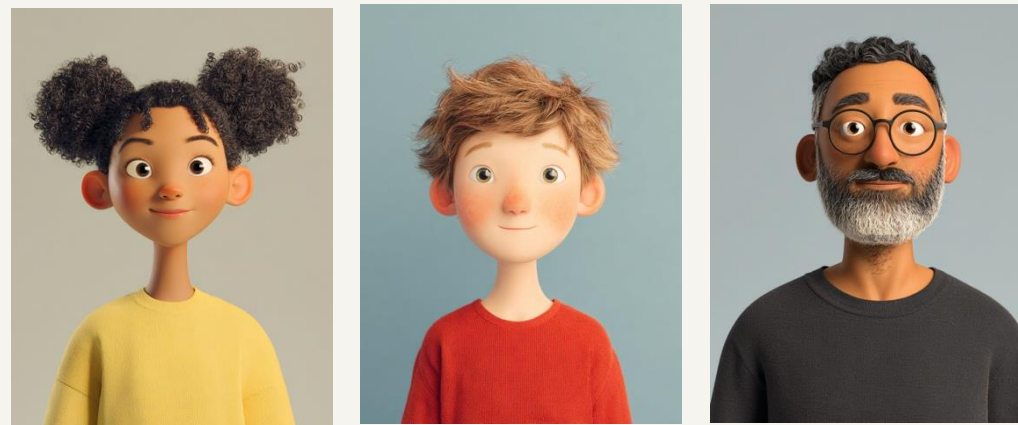
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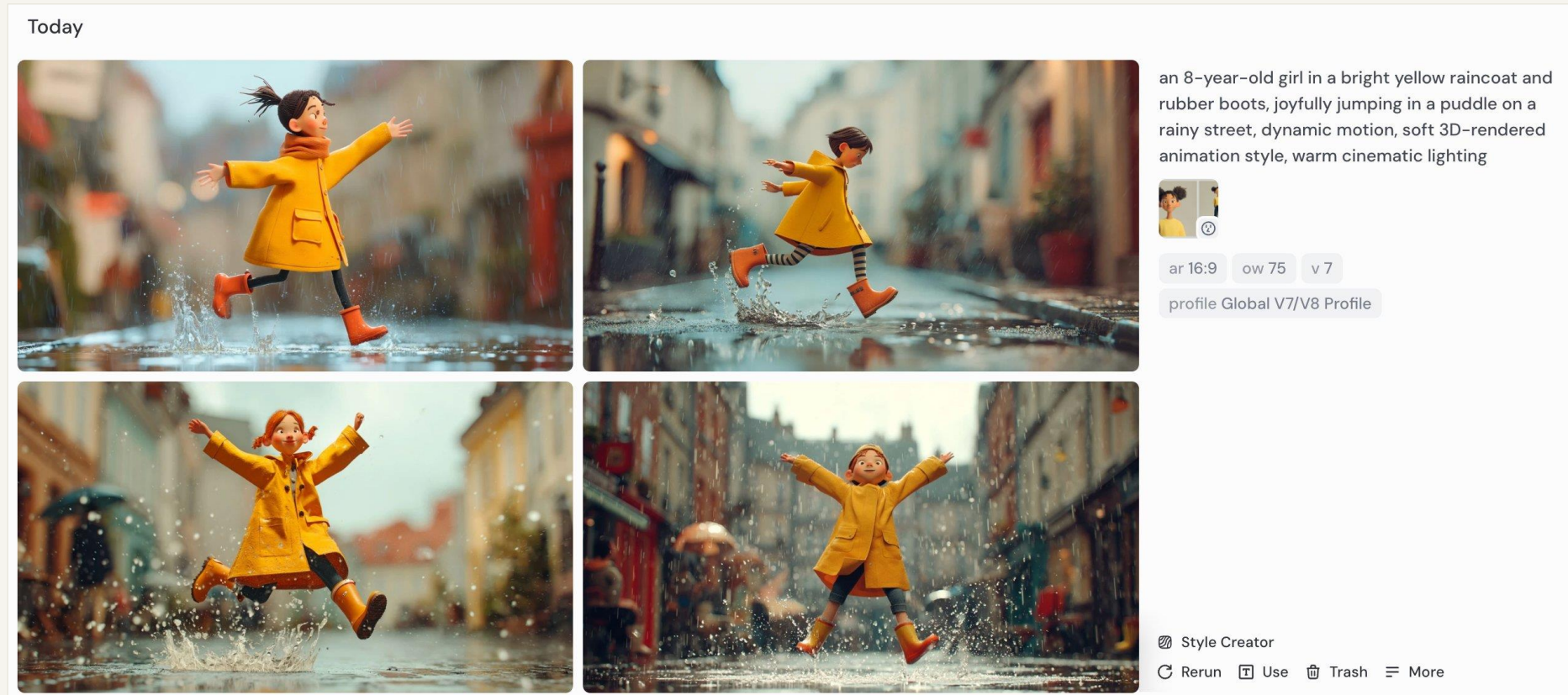
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Bug #1 — same reference, different outputs

First test: total failure — four random kids instead of my character.



reference



The weight dial runs 0–1000, not 0–100 — I set 75 ≈ “off.”

Bug #2 — style drift

Some characters came back as photos, others as flat 2D — inconsistent style.



Photoreal — too real



Flat 2D — too flat



Glossy 3D — the target

Fix: negative prompting — “not flat, not 2D, not painterly.” Pin a style from both sides.

UX • User control and freedom

lidjourney

⑦ Explore

 Create

Edit

Organize

ESTHETICS

 Personalize

Moodboards

 Style Creator

COMMUNITY

Tasks

 Help

 Updates

 Light Mode

sinless2399 ...

side-by-side animated-render character reference LEFT: close-up face, warm dignified neutral expression, all facial detail visible; RIGHT: full body head to toe including shoes a man in his early 70s, **dark brown skin, bald head**, short white beard, warm dignified face, larger rounded build, plain cream crew-neck t-shirt, dark trousers, tan sneakers, plain light-grey background, soft 3D-rendered Pixar-style animation, stylized not photorealistic, warm cinematic lighting

☺ Image Prompts



Use the elements of an image

Style References

Use the style of an image

② Omni Reference

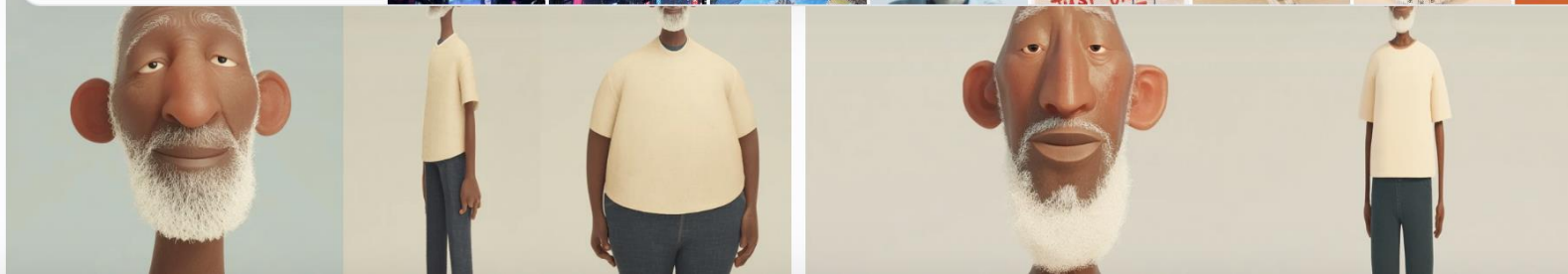
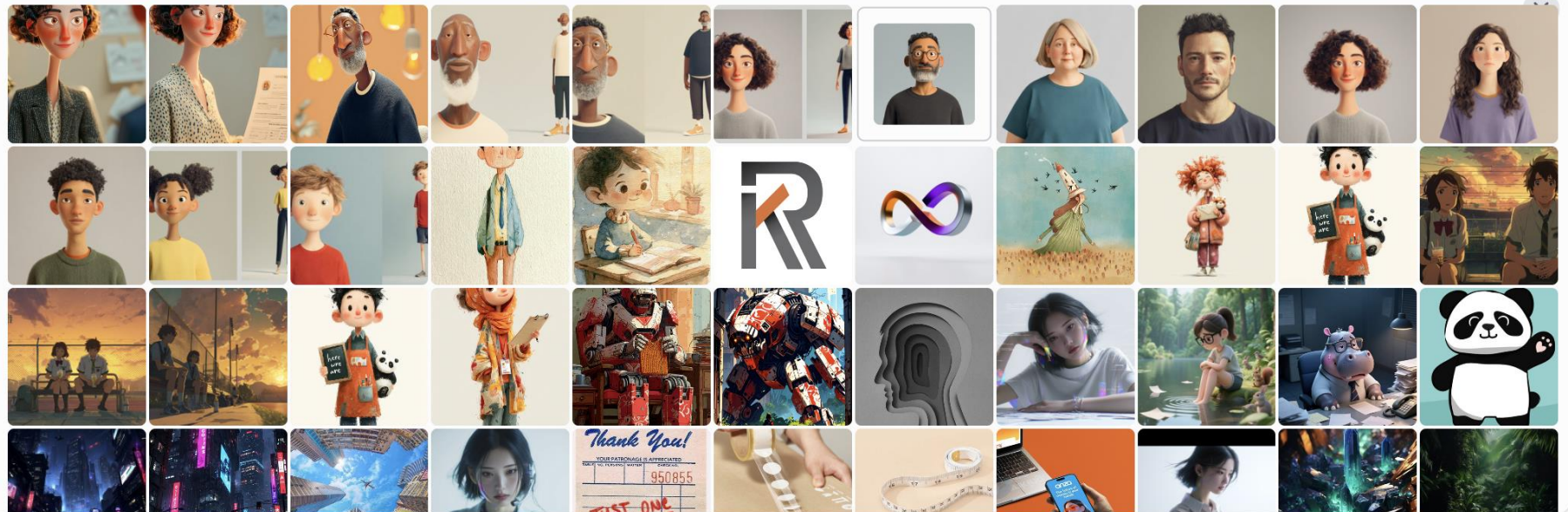
Use a person's likeness, or an object's form



“Do I have full control of each character?”



Upload a file or
drop it here



The reference-sheet trick

One image to hold the face steady: a close-up face, plus the full body, side by side.



A plain background strips the noise so the face becomes the signal.

The key idea: identity ≠ role

A master character turnaround you re-costume per scene.

Role-locked — wrong

“The Candidate,” baked into an interview suit. Single-use; useless for the next topic.

“Can we build characters that are scene-agnostic?”

Identity-only — right

Just a person — face, hair, build, plain background. Outfit and scene are added per shot.



Reusable assets, accelerators for a task you repeat every video.

Meet the cast

Ten characters — kids to seniors, varied builds — castable into almost any human scene.

***“Have I made sure
all the characters
share a similar
style?”***



Leo · 7



Aisha · 8



Marcus · 16



Sofia · 15



Maya · 20s



Theo · 30s



Diane · 50s



Raj · 50s



Eleanor · 70s



Walter · 70s

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The result



Maya — the same character from her reference sheet, now animated, in a new outfit, editing a resume.

Same face throughout the short, never the same shot twice. The library works end to end.



Projects

App Preview

My Media

Audio & Video

Titles

Backgrounds

Transitions

PROJECT MEDIA

App Preview

LIBRARIES

Photos

All Events

iMovie Library

19-6-26

iMovie Library

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▼ Interview (4)



▼ App Preview (6)



“Can I not follow Claude’s suggestions entirely?”

How to Crush a Job Interview

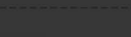
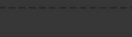
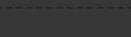
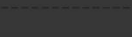
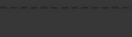
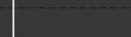
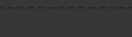
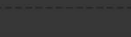
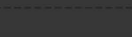
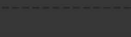
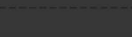
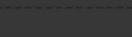
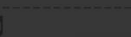
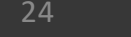
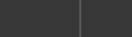
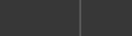
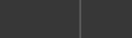
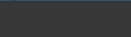
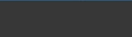
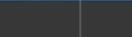
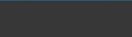
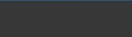
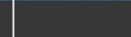
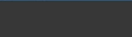
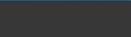
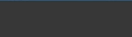
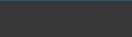


The question you ask is:

00:19 / 00:24

Settings





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App Preview

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▼ App Preview (6)



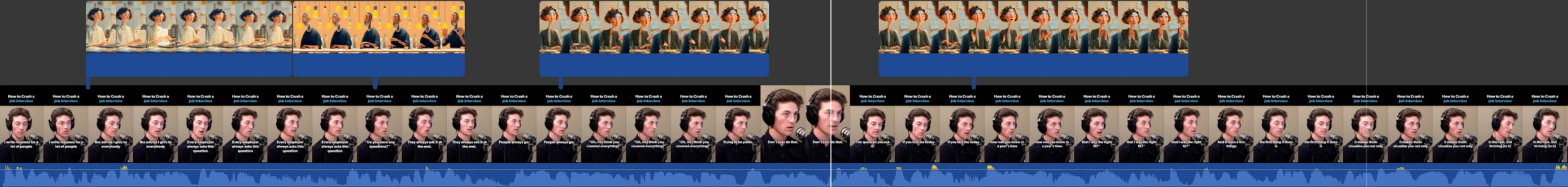
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How to Crush a Job Interview



00:19 / 00:24

Settings



25

Package it as a reusable Skill

Once it worked, I saved the whole recipe so it never has to be re-figured.

Ten reference sheets + each character's identity notes

The scene-prompt template

Every rule learned the hard way (the weight scale, the negatives)

The system holds the knowledge, not your head. Programmers call this DRY.

Human in the loop

The AI set everything up; a human made every judgment call.

AI maps the prompts to each beat

Human generates, picks the keepers, reuses variations

Human tunes, edits, and cuts the final piece

The AI proposes; the human decides — a useful frame for teaching with AI, too.

How to Crush a Job Interview



The final output

- Short-form video
- Talking head
- AI generated scenarios
- Animated b-rolls

亚裔为何更爱同族恋爱



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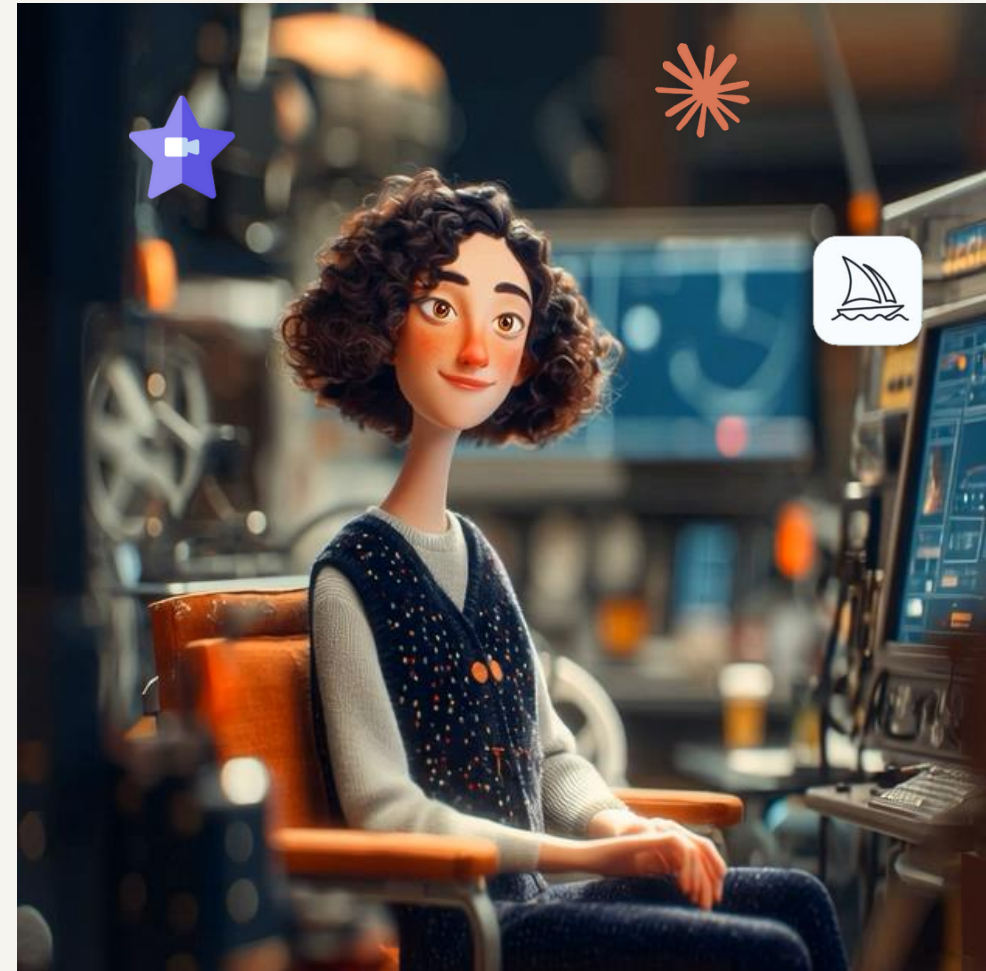
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The honest footnote

Claude never rendered a pixel. It analysed, wrote, and structured — I directed and edited.

That's also UX lens at work: usability thinking applied to a workflow, turning tools that fight you into a process that works for you — and you don't need to write a line of code to do it.



Thank you. — Questions?